



August

9

2019

Ace acrobat

At the US National Gymnastics Championships in Kansas City, USA, gymnast Simone Biles stunned the judges and the audience by pulling off a “double-double” dismount on the balance beam – a feat that had never been performed in a competition before.

Born this day

1914 Tove Jansson, Finnish author and cartoonist. She wrote a series of books and comic strips featuring a family of hippo-like characters called the Moomins.

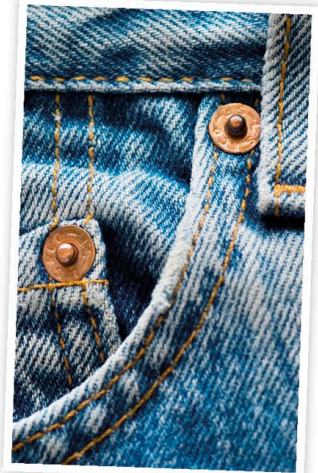
1993 Dipa Karmakar, Indian gymnast. She was the first female Indian gymnast to compete at the Olympics.

Blue jeans

US entrepreneur

Levi Strauss and tailor Jacob Davis filed a patent for a pair of durable trousers made out of a thick cotton fabric called denim for the workers in California’s gold mines. Denim jeans have since become an everyday item of clothing.

1872



Also on this day

1942 Indian leader Mahatma Gandhi launched the Quit India Movement, demanding an end to British rule in India.

1945 US forces dropped a second atomic bomb – code-named “Fat Man” – over Nagasaki, Japan, during World War II.

2007 The bald eagle was removed from the US list of Threatened and Endangered Species after successful efforts to protect its habitat.

Super sprinter

Black American sprinter

1936

Jesse Owens won his fourth gold medal in the 4x100 m relay race at the Berlin Olympics, after winning the 100 m, 200 m, and long jump events. His victories challenged German leader Adolf Hitler’s views on white supremacy.

